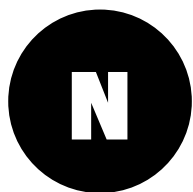


CHRO POWER SHIFT

FORGET HR METRICS, TODAY'S CHRO IS DRIVING
GROWTH, RISK, AND THE FUTURE OF WORK

BY **MAMTA SHARMA**

| 67



NOT TOO LONG ago, the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) was measured only by metrics: hiring numbers, attrition rates, engagement scores.

Today, that playbook is going through an overhaul.

In boardrooms shaped by the artificial intelligence (AI) disruption, economic volatility, and a workforce that refuses to wait, the CHRO is no longer managing people processes, they are shaping business outcomes. The role has moved from tracking performance to defining it, from supporting strategy to actively building it.

“The most effective CHROs are those involved early in decision-making. They are asking critical questions—do we have the right skills for the future, how do we stay flexible, and what kind of leadership do we need?” says Nishchae Suri, Managing Director, Cornerstone On-Demand India, a global provider of cloud-based talent management and learning experience solutions.

He emphasises that it's not just about supporting decisions anymore, it's about having a point of view, and being able to challenge, guide, and shape those decisions.

“Technology, talent and leadership are changing the way we work. Companies need to focus on skills, not jobs. Those who can make this change happen will define what the role of the CHRO looks like in ten years,” Suri adds.

Adding a business leader's perspective, Sandip Ghose, CEO of MP Birla Cement and a corporate strategist, notes: “Much of the traditional CHRO role is now pushed down to line managers. The nature of work and the nature of the workforce have both changed.”

He further underscores the shift in value creation: “Earlier, HR was built around efficiency, KPI achievement, percentages, output. Today, the shift is towards impact. Impact must come with speed. Time horizons have collapsed. You can't wait five years for success anymore.”